

Your **Baccalaureate Examination** (“bacc”) is the oral defense of your senior thesis and the culmination of your NCF education. Here’s how to schedule it and what to bring.

How to Schedule Your Bacc

1. Get your sponsor’s approval.

A bacc may be held only with your sponsor’s approval. Confirm you’re ready to defend before anything else.

2. Coordinate with your committee.

Find a two-hour window that works for all three (or more) members. Aim for **Bacc Days — April 27-29**— when faculty schedules are protected, and everyone’s availability is easier to align.

3. Reserve a room.

At least one week before the exam, contact your sponsor’s **Division office manager** to reserve a space. Bring your date, time, committee names, and thesis title.

4. Post the announcement.

Once your room is confirmed, submit the [Baccalaureate Announcement form](#) to announce your defense to the campus community. Baccs are open to anyone who wants to attend. You can find the schedule of announced baccs [here](#).

5. Send your thesis to your committee.

Deliver a final copy to every member at least one week before the defense — earlier is better.

Key Deadlines

- Submit the [Application for Graduation](#) the term before you intend to graduate.
- **January graduates:** bacc by the end of the last full week of ISP.
- **May graduates:** bacc by the last day of Spring classes.
- **Thesis to Library:** digital copy by the Monday of Finals Week ([submission instructions](#)).
- **Library Copy Due:** The library copy of the senior thesis is due no later than 5:00 p.m. on the Monday before graduation.

What to Bring on the Day

- Completed [Baccalaureate Student Audit](#). Fill it out and print it — your committee reviews it during the private portion to confirm you’ve met your AO and general-education requirements. [Instructions for filling it out](#).
- **A copy of your thesis.** Bring a clean printed or digital copy for reference.
- **Presentation materials.** Slides, handouts, or media. Test the room’s tech beforehand.
- **Water and a pen.** Seriously — you’ll want both

What Happens in the Room

- **Opening presentation.** Begin with a focused talk on what’s most significant about your project. Follow your sponsor’s directions for this presentation.
- **Committee Q&A.** Questions about your thesis, AOC, and broader education. Audience may ask at the committee’s discretion.
- **Private discussion.**
- Audience steps out and committee asks questions about your time at New College
- **Deliberation.** You and the audience step out while the committee discusses and completes paperwork.
- **The outcome.** The committee invites you back and shares their decision.

HELPFUL RESOURCES

[Senior Thesis Project Resources](#) • [WRC Thesis Writing Guide](#) • [Cook Library Research Guide](#) • [Catalog: Senior Project or Thesis](#)

Questions? *Start with your thesis sponsor. For procedural questions, contact your Division office manager or the Office of the Provost.*